8.9.2 Drones in news collection and field journalism

In journalism, drones have become critical for gathering imagery and situational information in areas where human access is limited, dangerous, or restricted. UAVs allow field reporters to document natural disasters, conflict zones, protests, remote settlements, and hazardous industrial sites without endangering personnel. Their ability to fly low and access narrow or obstructed areas provides unique vantage points that complement groundbased reporting and satellite imagery.

Drones also support investigative and data-driven journalism, enabling long-duration surveillance for evidence collection in environmental violation cases, illegal mining operations, deforestation monitoring, and pollution mapping. The integration of UAV footage into news broadcasts adds depth and credibility to reporting by providing visually verifiable spatial context. However, their use in journalism also requires strong adherence to ethical and legal standards, particularly regarding privacy rights, flight authorization, public safety, and responsible narrative framing.

8.9.3 Creative and commercial uses in art and advertising

Beyond news and entertainment, drones have introduced innovative artistic and commercial possibilities in visual design and experiential communication. In advertising, UAVs enable attention-grabbing aerial product showcases, large-scale landscape branding shots, and immersive storytelling experiences. Drone light shows, where fleets of UAVs equipped with LED modules perform coordinated formations, have begun to replace fireworks at major celebrations, representing a sustainable, programmable, and visually synchronized art form.

In contemporary art practice, drones are used as interactive performance instruments, mobile projection platforms, and choreographed aerial